

There are software available for making time-lapse videos out there. One free software that can be used for this purpose is VirtualDub, (<http://www.virtualdub.org>). Start the program, go to File > Open Video File and check 'Automatically Load Linked Segments'. Then, open the first file from the series to be used in the Time-Lapse video. The program automatically loads the other images if they are serially numbered. A time-lapse video can be created in Windows Movie Maker, but the lowest duration allowed for importing a photo is 0.125 seconds, which can be a pain. You need to render the movie, and then speed it up using the speed filter. You can use any video editing software for this purpose. Most video software will render the video in a much lower resolution than the resolution you selected, which is ideal for uploading on the internet, or sharing with friends via email.

Once you are familiar with time-lapses, you can move onto more advanced things. Play around with the exposure timing of the camera. Using large exposure timings on things like crowds or a waterfall to give a blurred effect to the video, and accentuate the sense of movement. Taking a long exposure time-lapse video of moving traffic on a road during the night will make those trails of white and red come alive with movement. For most time-lapse subjects, a long exposure will have little or no effect as everything is moving slowly anyway.

Experiment with time lapses where the camera is stationary inside a moving vehicle – like a train journey or a long drive with friends captured from the dashboard. Moving the camera itself while shooting a time-lapse, even a basic movement like a pan or a zoom is going to give some startling effect to the time lapse. Usually, professionals use programmed and customised rigs for this effect, but there is no reason why you should not experiment with your digital camera and tripod. Try rotating the head of the tripod by a fraction of a degree between shots, or moving the tripod itself.

8.1 HDR

HDR stands for high dynamic range, and preserves the details of an image across a wide range of luminosity. For example, a façade against the backdrop of a sky during dusk will give an image where either the sky is too bright and the building is